Eric R. Xu, Ph.D.

ANALYTICS DATA ENGINEER | CUSTOMER REPORTING · DASHBOARDS · SQL · DATA STORYTELLING
eric.r.xu@gmail.com | 317.828.9007 | San Francisco Bay Area | Personal Website

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Analytics-focused data engineer with 10+ years turning complex data into trusted reports, dashboards, and metrics for customers and internal stakeholders at Apple, Meta, DoorDash, and Inmar. Strong in SQL, Snowflake, dbt, Looker, and Tableau, with data-quality checks built into every dataset. Delivered client-facing Looker reporting that analytically rigorous advertisers validated daily, and self-service BI that cut ad hoc requests. Ph.D. in Psychological & Brain Sciences; explains technical results clearly to non-technical audiences and thrives on ambiguous problems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Analytics & Reporting: SQL (Snowflake, Presto/Trino, Spark/Hive, PostgreSQL, MySQL) · R · Looker · Tableau · Metabase · dbt · dashboard development · KPI & metric definition · A/B testing · data storytelling

Data Engineering & Quality: Python · Airflow · dimensional modeling · custom data-quality checks · anomaly detection · monitoring/alerting · Elasticsearch · Git · pytest · Docker · Kubernetes · PR-gated CI/CD

Ingestion & AI: REST APIs · webhooks · AWS S3 · in-app event data · LLM agents · RAG · vector search (Qdrant) · human-in-the-loop workflows

EXPERIENCE

TileSense, Mahjong Trainer | *Independent Project* 2026 – Present

- Shipped a cross-platform Flutter app (PostgreSQL backend, Dockerized multiplayer service) with in-app event tracking; modeled gameplay data in dbt for A/B testing AI bots, built Metabase dashboards for Daily Active Devices and retention, and designed a mahjong-strategy model that outperforms existing OpenRiichi bots.

Apple | *Data Engineer (contracted by TEKsystems)* 03/2025 – 09/2026

- Partnered with Engineering, Product, and marketing to turn ambiguous requirements into metric definitions, pipelines, and Tableau reporting; built CronJob pipelines with custom data-quality checks and PR-validated deployment.
- Built LLM-based alert-triage services on Kubernetes (Python/SQL on Presto/Trino, Slack Bolt): RAG enrichment and automatic red/yellow/green severity classification, with a human-in-the-loop Slack modal whose corrections take precedence in real time. Improved real-issue detection 35% YoY, cut false positives 30–40%, and raised alert engagement 20%.

DoorDash | *Analytics Data Engineer (contracted by TEKsystems)* 08/2024 – 02/2025

- Designed layered analytics transformations and serving datasets in Snowflake, and self-service BI for in-store deals, supporting market expansion, redemption, conversion, and cohort analysis.
- Defined reusable metric logic, automated data-quality checks, and experiment launch monitoring, informing UI strategies that improved conversion efficiency by 5–10%; built forecasting and milestone tracking across 50K+ redemptions, reducing ad hoc analysis.

Meta | *Senior Analytics Data Engineer* 07/2020 – 04/2024

- Designed and owned Spark/Hive/Presto pipelines and star-schema tables (raw → curated → serving) supporting analytics, experimentation, and high-traffic consumer products; built reusable reporting datasets and KPI frameworks, with pytest-tested PR deployment and custom data-quality checks.
- Partnered with Instagram Identity, Brand, and Teen Safety stakeholders and London colleagues across time zones to validate assumptions, communicate data limitations, and deliver metrics supporting account-recovery and risk-reduction work.
- Built a CPU-savings metric into Meta's internal Team Insights UI (learned PHP to ship it) that made pipeline optimization visible in performance reviews, driving a 15% increase in CPU savings per pipeline diff; set team metrics with Data Scientists, measured impact via A/B tests with holdouts, carried a weekly on-call rotation, and mentored new hires.

Inmar Intelligence | OwnerIQ | *Senior Data Engineer / Senior Data Scientist* 07/2015 – 06/2020

- Built incremental ROAS measurement for advertiser clients: an Elasticsearch k-NN lookalike model comparing exposed users with statistically similar unexposed users across billions of records, joined with CRM and offline POS data and orchestrated in Airflow.
- Delivered daily-refreshed Looker dashboards (Presto) that let clients validate incremental results themselves, meeting the standards of analytically rigorous advertisers.
- Managed a data product analytics team (2 direct reports) for 3 years, leading end-to-end delivery of 8+ production data products with stakeholder acceptance.
- Built internal analytics tools (including a Python Flask app for data-product requests), custom data-quality checks, and Looker KPI reporting that standardized commerce measurement and reduced manual analysis.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Psychological & Brain Sciences (cognitive neuroscience; affective decision-making) — Dartmouth College
Certificate, Data Science & Machine Learning — MIT Schwarzman College of Computing Nov 2024
B.S., Biomedical Engineering (Biomechanics) — Case Western Reserve University